

in the day-to-day, or how the smartphone performs in synthetic benchmarks.

Let's first get the numbers out of the way. The smartphone showcased similar scores to its latest competitors - the Realme GT6 and the Xiaomi 14 CIVI. The Moto Edge 50 Ultra also beats the OnePlus 12R in CPU-based benchmarks like AnTuTu and Geekbench 6. Even in GPU-based benchmarks, the Moto Edge 50 Ultra came at-par with the competition, but came ahead of the Xiaomi 14 CIVI in GFXBench benchmark.

Now talking about the usage, here also the Moto Edge 50 Ultra is as good as any flagship smartphone. I felt no lags or slowdowns while using the smartphone. App opening speeds are as good as any flagship out there, there are no lags or slowdowns, and best of all, the software is stable and very clean. I also tried out some other features from Motorola like the Smart Connect feature which lets you connect your Motorola smartphone to a Windows laptop seamlessly.

I also tried out some AI features of the Moto Edge 50 Ultra. These include create AI Magic Canvas which allows users to generate their own wallpapers with just text prompts. There is also Style Sync, which will let you click a photo of yourself and based on that photo, create a wallpaper for you. Many AI features are also limited to the camera. For example the AI action shot, intelligent auto focus tracking, and the likes.

And while we are at AI, this is my first review that also includes Digit's latest AI-Q scoring. We ran our AI tests and looked at the features on the Moto Edge 50 Ultra and the smartphone fared very well in our AI score. The Moto Edge 50 Ultra scored a total of 38.33 points out of 100.

Throughout, the Moto Edge 50 Ultra didn't give me much issues. While gaming, the smartphone did heat up a bit. It also throttles a lot. Upon noticing heating, I ran the CPU Throttling test on the Moto Edge 50 Ultra and the smartphone throttled to 57 percent of its performance, which isn't really good for our gamer friends out there. Other than that, the performance is pretty good and this feels as slick as any flagship out there.

BATTERY AND CHARGING

The battery on the Moto Edge 50 Ultra is a rather small 4,500mAh unit. However, the backup is decent. While I was only able to get about 6 hours of on-screen time on heavy usage without inserting my SIM in the smartphone, in battery tests this smartphone did fairly well.

In a 15 minute Call of Duty: Mobile gaming session, the smartphone lost 4 percent of the battery. Watching YouTube for 30 minutes on the highest resolution made the smartphone lose only 3 percent of the battery, and it lasted a fairly decent 802 minutes which is more than 13 hours in the video loop test. For a 4,500mAh battery, this is good output. However, I have my doubts about using the smartphone more extensively and the battery still giving similar backup in the longer run.

The charging, however, is absolutely bonkers. The Moto Edge 50 Ultra comes with 125W fast charging, making it one of the fastest charging phones in the market right now. It also has a much smaller 4,500mAh battery as compared to other devices in the range. Combine this and the Moto Edge 50 Ultra charged from 0 to 100 percent in just about 20 minutes! This is probably the fastest I have seen any smartphone charge from nothing to full.

So yes, even if the battery backup doesn't remain good in the longer run, the overall experience is sorted since this is one of the fastest charging that I have personally ever seen on any smartphone so far. Only maybe the OnePlus 10R and Realme GT Neo3 from a couple of years back gave a similar charging experience.

CAMERA

We get a triple rear camera setup with the Moto Edge 50 Ultra. I will start with the main point - I like the front camera on this more than the rear camera. Now, while getting good images isn't very difficult with this setup, the Moto Edge 50 Ultra isn't the best camera smartphone out there. Things are very simple here. There aren't many things going on and Motorola's tuning also looks to be quite basic, with a hint of vibrancy which is a safe approach.

I love having a telephoto shooter in any camera setup that I use and this is

no exception. It is limited to 6x, but the optical zoom is pretty good. The details remain intact, and we get enough range to play around with different perspectives.

In extreme low light, this camera really struggles. Even with the night mode on, you can't see a lot of details. However, things aren't as bad in slightly less extreme situations. Portraits are also decent, the edge detection is just fine and the subject is cut out properly. There is also very minimal to no smoothing of the skin so that is good. Overall, this is just an average camera so those who want a decent camera but aren't much of photographers would definitely like this.

VERDICT

So the Moto Edge 50 Ultra is a phone that does pretty much everything good. It has a nice and different design and comes with a very good display. We also get enough power and might with the Qualcomm Snapdragon 8s Gen 3, and the camera is also decent. Yes, there are issues. It throttles quite a bit and the battery might give up in the longer run. However, we can argue that this is not a gaming phone and the super fast charging more than makes up for a time when the battery possibly degrades.

Best of all, the software is super clean. While 3 years of updates for a smartphone that costs Rs 55,000 is still quite less, it is something Motorola claims to be working on so we may see further improvement in the update cycles. Overall, however, it is a complete flagship. The smartphone also scores well in our AI tests and comes with enough AI features to keep up with the trend.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8s Gen 3 | GPU: Adreno 735 | OS: Hello UI based on Android 14 | Display: 6.7-inch FHD+ pOLED display | Display Refresh Rate: 144Hz | RAM: Up to 12GB | ROM: Up to 512GB | Cameras (rear): 50MP + 50MP + 64MP | Cameras (front): 50MP | Video: 4K @ 30fps | Battery: 4500mAh | Charging: 125W

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